

Instructions for Using Board Builder (Global Symbols)

Board Builder is an online tool that lets you quickly create communication boards using symbols from Global Symbols' extensive library. Here's how to get started and make the most of it.



1. Sign in to Global Symbols

1. Go to <https://app.globalsymbols.com/en/>
 2. Sign in with your account (or create one if needed).
 3. From the home page, choose **Board Builder/Create Boards**.
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2. Create a New Board

1. Click on "Create Board Set".
 2. Choose:
 - Give the Board a Title >Next
 - Board size > Template or Customise (e.g., 4x3, 6x6, 8x10 - no more than 36 cells)
 - Create
 3. Check Properties **three dots** ⋮ to the right of the left hand menu items e.g. Title and Board 1 for further options
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3. Add Symbols to the Board

1. Click on any empty cell.
2. Use the **symbol bar on the right** to add a label or concept.
3. Choose Symbol to generate an AI symbol, search the repository or use your own images.
4. The symbol will appear in the selected cell.

Tips:

- Try alternative search words if you don't find a symbol immediately.
 - When you used Symbol Creator AI keep prompts simple and select an appropriate culture.
 - You will be able to download symbols selected, save to cell and edit with Symbol Designer
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4. Edit a Symbol Cell

Click on a cell to open editing options:

You can:

- **Change the label** (the position in the cell can be changed using the Board properties ⋮)
 - **Change symbol to text only - select cell mode** > clear symbol (found at the bottom) and edit the label > the text will appear centred
 - **Adjust background and cell outline colour**
 - **Change text size or colour**
 - **Upload your own image** by using the upload feature in My images (you may want to keep the board private if the image is personal - see Board properties ⋮)
 - **Link to other Boards within a Board Set** once these have been created by using the Linking mechanism in the cell menu - linked boards become zipped .obz files for sharing with other communication apps that have this format.
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+ 5. Add, Remove, or Rearrange Cells

- **Add rows/columns** via the Board properties ⋮
 - **Add colour skin and hair tints** to .svg symbols (that have a small blue happy face 🧑)
 - **Move the location of cells** (found beneath the cell background changes) .
 - **Reset cell contents** - clear a symbol from a cell or clear skin and hair colour
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7. Saving Your Board

1. Your board is automatically stored in your own **Global Symbols Board Sets**.
2. You can reopen it any time to edit or duplicate it.

3. Duplication is possible by exporting it as an .obf file for on board or .obz file for multiple linked boards and then imported again into your own library - see Board properties ⋮
 4. Choose in the title Board properties ⋮ whether to make the board public to share with others.
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8. Export or Print Your Board

Board Builder allows you to:

- **Download as Board Set by using the Title properties** ⋮ The .obz linked board set will be seen in the device download folder as a zipped collection of the single boards that can be shared if **public** to make into a communication book.
- **Download individual Boards by using the properties** ⋮ The .obf linked board will be seen in the device download folder a single .obf file that can be shared if **public**, to make into a communication book.
- **Download/Print PDF** with options to:
 - change paper size, orientation and text size
 - use **Advanced Settings** for cell padding changes and adjust spacing between the image and label
 - note the symbol sets used and **check copyright licences**

Tips:

- Text size changes will be affected by symbol size and vice versa - no text and the image will fill the cell.
 - No copyright notice will be displayed with user's own images or AI generated images.
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9. Share or Collaborate

- In the future you will be able to **share boards** (if made public) via a link to a collection page.
- If enabled, collaborators will be able to view or copy your board.